

PAPER 1 Reading and
Use of English

PAPER 2 Writing ▶

PAPER 3 Listening

PAPER 4 Speaking

Essential tips

- ▶ Paper 2 consists of two parts. Part 1 of the Writing paper is compulsory for everyone. You will be asked to produce an essay in which you must develop and support an argument on a supplied topic. The essay should always be between 220 and 260 words.
- ▶ In Part 2 there are three writing tasks. You must choose one of the three to answer. The types of text you can choose to write will include: an email or letter (formal or informal), a proposal, a report or a review.
- ▶ You should practise producing each text type that appears in the test.
- ▶ The information you will need in order to plan and produce each written piece in the test is called the input text. This input text might take the form of a bulleted list, an advertisement, a notice, an announcement, etc. Always read the input text carefully to make sure you understand exactly what you are being asked to write.
- ▶ Pay particular attention to the purpose of each written piece and its target reader.
- ▶ It is very important to write each item in the appropriate register. Think about whether the language you use should be formal or informal. Ask yourself whether you need to sound neutral or persuasive.
- ▶ Be aware of the structure you will need to use for each item you write. For example, how should you organise the paragraphs in your essay and what must each one contain? In your report, should you use headings and lists?
- ▶ Plan before you write, but don't spend too much time drafting a rough version; you won't have time to rewrite it properly. Use your own words as far as possible.
- ▶ Get into the habit of learning what 220–260 words look like in the various forms required for the test. Try to ensure that your handwriting is clear. You may lose points if the examiner cannot read what you have written.
- ▶ Allow a few minutes before the end of the test to quickly read through your work, checking your spelling and punctuation.
- ▶ See the Writing bank on pp. 193–205 for examples of the different types of writing required for this test.

PAPER 1 Reading and
Use of English

PAPER 2 Writing

Part 1

PAPER 3 Listening

Part 2

PAPER 4 Speaking

Essential tips

- ▶ Read the instructions carefully. Note how many benefits you are asked to address.
- ▶ What can you learn from the input text? Does everyone who attended the public meeting feel the same about the proposal?
- ▶ When referring to the points made at the meeting, try to use your own words. Don't copy the information from the input text.
- ▶ What is the standard structure of an essay? What should you include in each part of it?
- ▶ Who is going to read the essay? What is the appropriate register you should use here?
- ▶ Are you required to simply report what happened at the meeting, or are you being asked to express your own opinion?

You **must** answer this question. Write your answer in **220–260** words in an appropriate style on the separate answer sheet.

- 1 Your class has attended a public meeting on a proposal to build a bypass around your town (a road that avoids the town). You have made the notes below.

Local politicians point out the following benefits of the bypass:

- a welcome reduction in pollution and noise
- improved transport links
- less traffic congestion in the town centre

Some opinions expressed in the meeting:

"Traders in the town will suffer economically."

"Land will have to be cleared, and we are concerned about the impact on the environment."

"What about loss of revenue when tourists no longer visit sites of historical interest in the town?"

Write an essay for your tutor discussing **two** of the benefits in your notes. You should **explain whether you think the advantages of the bypass outweigh the disadvantages** and **provide reasons** to support your opinion.

You may, if you wish, make use of the opinions expressed in the meeting, but you should use your own words as far as possible.

PAPER 1 Reading and
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PAPER 2 Writing

Part 1

PAPER 3 Listening

Part 2

PAPER 4 Speaking

Essential tips

- ▶ In this part of the test, you will have the opportunity to express yourself more imaginatively and creatively.
- ▶ Remember, you only need to choose one task in Part 2 of the Writing paper.
- ▶ Read each of the three questions carefully. Choose the one that you are most comfortable with.

Question 2

- ▶ Read the input text carefully. Who is the email from?
- ▶ How will you organise and structure your proposal? Remember, it is important to show that you have understood what you need to do here, and to present your proposal in a clear way.
- ▶ What idea could you propose? Don't spend too much time trying to think of the best possible idea. However, make sure that your idea directly relates to improving the employees' working experience.
- ▶ What is the appropriate register to use here?
- ▶ Plan before you begin writing. Do you have enough points to make in order to meet the required word count of 220–260?

Question 3

- ▶ What sort of letter do you think is called for here: formal, semi-formal or informal?
- ▶ Check that you remember how to set out a letter in English.
- ▶ As always, pay attention to the instructions and don't leave anything out. Note, for

Write an answer to **one** of the questions **2–4** in this part. Write your answer in **220–260** words in an appropriate style on the separate answer sheet. Put the question number in the box at the top of the page.

- 2 You have received the following email from the Managing Director at your place of work.

Dear Colleagues,

I am pleased to announce that a generous budget of £3,000 has been set aside to improve the working experience of everyone at the company. I invite all employees to submit a proposal outlining how they feel this money would best be spent. Please illustrate exactly how you believe your proposal will positively impact everyday life at the company. The most popular proposal will be implemented.

Good luck!

Margaret Wheeler

CEO

Write your **proposal**.

- 3 In your local newspaper, you have just read an article heavily criticising students' behaviour in the town, outside of school hours. Write a letter to the editor and include the following information:

- your overall reaction to the article
- specific points that you agree or disagree with, and why
- a suggestion for a follow-up article.

Write your **letter**.

- 4 You see this ad on a community noticeboard.

New Book Group

We need your help to compile a reading list of book titles for our new book group! So far, we have 20 members; men and women ranging in age from 17 to 58. Please send us your review of a novel that you think will appeal to our group members, giving reasons for your choice. Thank you.

Write your **review**.

example, that one of the bullet points asks you to mention specific points which you agree or disagree with, giving your reasons why.

- ▶ What key phrases are you likely to need for expressing agreement, disagreement and opinions?

Question 4

- ▶ Read the ad carefully. Who is the book review for?
- ▶ Note that you are not necessarily required to write about a book that you like; the objective is to recommend

a novel that will appeal to the group members.

- ▶ Mention the genre of the novel. For example, is it crime fiction, a romantic novel, a thriller, etc.?
- ▶ Stick to the structure of a book review, outlining the plot and demonstrating a clear understanding of the themes and the main characters.
- ▶ Balanced book reviews tend to be more effective than reviews which are entirely positive or entirely negative.